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Agree scope and decisions

Astral customer discovery
Activity 1 of 7 · Draft for review · October 2026

Activity 1
Agree scope and decisions



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ACTIVITY 1 OF 7

Agree scope and decisions

Agree what the research must help decide, the priority journeys, and what is out of scope.

PROVISIONAL DURATION

1 to 2 weeks

DEPENDS ON

Time with Clive and the manager. Access to existing interview notes

OUTPUT

Agreed research questions, priority journeys, exclusions, and an existing-evidence summary.

WHAT WE NEED FROM REVIEWERS

- **Review this plan** and agree or change the scope, the decisions it supports, and the provisional timeline.
- **Agree the first research decisions with Clive.** Which journeys matter most and what is out of scope.
- **Access to Clive and Emily Haddon's existing customer interview notes.** So we build on them, not repeat them.

THE SEVEN ACTIVITIES

1	**Agree scope and decisions**
2	Set up recruitment
3	Discovery round 1
4	Discovery round 2, targeted
5	Survey
6	Integrate and follow up
7	Test design implications

PRIMARY RESEARCH QUESTION

How do IMSERV customers do their energy-data work today, and which differences in that work should change how Astral is designed and prioritised?

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What happens

What happens

Agree what the research must help decide, the priority journeys, and what is out of scope.

1

Agree decisions and exclusions

Session with Clive and the manager to agree the decisions and exclusions.

2

Choose priority scenarios

Agree two or three priority scenarios to follow in depth.

3

Agree the route to the BA team

Agree how findings reach the BA team.

4

Review existing evidence

Review Clive and Emily Haddon's customer interview notes, DataVision walk notes, and any support or usage data.

5

Record what is already answered

Record what those sources already answer, so we do not ask again.

Possible starting scenarios

Two or three priority scenarios to follow in depth. To confirm, not agreed.

Scenario	Status
Getting access and reaching usable data	To confirm
Investigating a discrepancy through to resolution	To confirm
Preparing and sharing evidence for a business decision	To confirm

Decision to inform

- Which customer tasks and journeys Astral should prioritise for version one and after.
- Which behavioural differences need different designs, defaults, or trade-offs.
- Where problems sit in the service and process, not the interface. So we do not try to fix ownership or data quality with screen copy.
- What the BA team should specify next, with evidence behind each story.

Agree how findings reach the BA team

- Round 1 findings are shared with the BA team as they emerge, marked provisional
- Stories link back to the need and evidence behind them
- The BA team (Claire and others) can bring open story questions into round 2

What we already know

Record what these sources already answer, so we do not ask again. Every item has a source and a limit.

Evidence	Source	Limit
Clive and Emily Haddon did a dozen or more customer interviews. The notes sit with Clive	Work Desk notes, 4 Sep 2026	We have not seen the notes. We do not know who was interviewed or what was asked
British Gas and Scottish Water asked to take part in the beta	Work Desk notes, 4 Sep 2026	A route to customers. Not a sample
Customers want to see their own estate, know meters are working, get invoices and reports, and follow problems. Export is more common than looking at graphs	Max Lake, DataVision walk, 4 Sep 2026	Internal account of customer behaviour. Not observed with customers
People pick sites and meters, compare them, then export a file. They do not browse the whole portfolio	Max Lake, 4 Sep 2026	As above
Company types are Customer, Broker / TPI, Supplier, and Platform admin. A Customer has Energy, Finance, Asset, and Data working hats	IMSERV customer base, desk research, 12 Sep 2026	Public-page desk research. Not a study
Access has three separate parts: what the company bought, the person's role, and which sites and documents they can see	Astral product model, 22 Sep 2026	From the handoff transcript. The role matrix is still open
Large customers narrow from the whole portfolio, to a region, to sites, to one MPAN. One customer has about 8,000 MPANs	As above	Named in a talk. Not observed

Assumed and not yet known

The research repository has no studies, insights, archetypes, or experience scores yet.

ASSUMED

- The Energy, Finance, Asset, and Data hats describe how people work. They are a useful recruitment start. They may not be four archetypes.
- Customers mostly use Astral for reporting. Reporting may mean pulling data that is finished somewhere else.
- The people a senior contact introduces us to are the people who do the day-to-day work.
- Problems people raise about the portal are interface problems. Some may be service, process, or data-quality problems.

UNKNOWN

- Who actually logs in today and who just receives a file.
- What starts the work, what people check before they trust a figure, and where the work leaves the portal.
- Who does the work, who approves it, and who receives the result.
- Which behaviour patterns recur across organisations and roles.
- How often those patterns happen across a wider set of customers.
- Where the journey breaks down, and whether the cause is the interface or the service behind it.

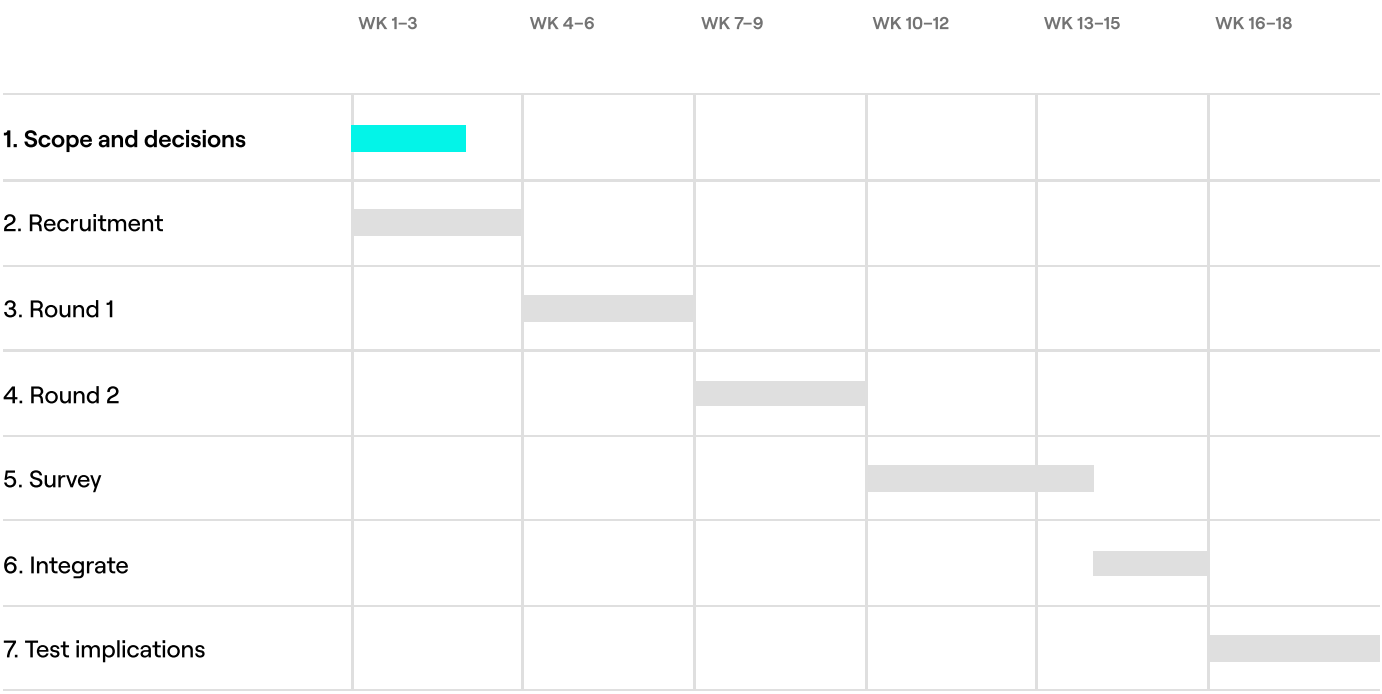
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Plan and safeguards

Where it sits

Estimates to agree, not commitments. Bars show the upper estimate for each stage. With overlap, roughly 12 to 18 weeks from agreement to tested implications.



Stage	Provisional duration	Depends on
1. Agree scope and decisions	1 to 2 weeks	Time with Clive and the manager. Access to existing interview notes

What we are asking for

This plan is the proposal for the conversation with Clive. He has **not** agreed a research plan, scope, or sample size.

	Ask	Status
1	**Review this plan** and agree or change the scope, the decisions it supports, and the provisional timeline.	To agree
2	**Agree the first research decisions with Clive.** Which journeys matter most and what is out of scope.	To agree
5	**Access to Clive and Emily Haddon's existing customer interview notes.** So we build on them, not repeat them.	To agree

Decision to inform

- Which customer tasks and journeys Astral should prioritise for version one and after.
- Which behavioural differences need different designs, defaults, or trade-offs.
- Where problems sit in the service and process, not the interface. So we do not try to fix ownership or data quality with screen copy.
- What the BA team should specify next, with evidence behind each story.

None of this is a finding yet

Everything here is a proposed approach. It is grounded in UX and mixed-methods guidance. **None of it is a finding about IMSERV customers yet.**

Risks and limits

What could weaken the evidence, and what we do about it.

Risk	Effect	Mitigation
Existing interview notes are not available	We repeat work, or miss context	Ask Clive early. Record what they cover
Recruitment or privacy approval is slow	The timeline moves	Start both in stage 1. Share early findings from round 1
Archetypes are expected before evidence exists	A persona deck without support	Agree upfront that archetypes emerge from rounds 1 and 2

Agreed research questions, priority journeys, exclusions, and an existing-evidence summary.

Output

Early findings reach the BA team from round 1, not only at the end.

Hands over to

Activity 2. Set up recruitment.

Reach the people who actually do the work, across several organisations.

Working alongside the BA team

- Round 1 findings are shared with the BA team as they emerge, marked provisional
- Stories link back to the need and evidence behind them
- The BA team (Claire and others) can bring open story questions into round 2



Thank You

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